Crane Operation Checklist (29 CFR 1926.1417)

Use before starting the crane and during lifts to check operation against 29 CFR 1926.1417.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.1417

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. Where a Defect means the equipment needs adjustment or repair, the operator reports it in writing to the person the employer designated and, on successive shifts, to the next operator (1926.1417(j)(1)).
3. The manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add further checks.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.1417: Operation (Part 1926 Subpart CC, Cranes and Derricks in Construction) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-1417-operation

SECTION A | Procedures, cab documents and tags

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Manufacturer procedures Ref. 1926.1417(a)	Operation follows the manufacturer's procedures for the equipment's functions and for any attachment in use.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Procedures where manufacturer's are unavailable Ref. 1926.1417(b)(1)	Employer-developed procedures for safe operation of the equipment and attachments exist and are being followed.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Operational control procedures Ref. 1926.1417(b)(2)	Employer procedures for the operational controls were developed by a qualified person.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Capacity procedures Ref. 1926.1417(b)(3)	Employer capacity procedures were developed and signed by a registered professional engineer familiar with the equipment.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Load charts and manual Ref. 1926.1417(c)(1)	Load charts, recommended operating speeds, special hazard warnings, instructions and the operator's manual are readily available in the cab at all times for the operator.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Electronic load charts Ref. 1926.1417(c)(2)	Operator knows to cease operations immediately or follow safe shut-down procedures if electronic rated capacities become inaccessible, and not to resume until rated capacities are available again in electronic or other form.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Out-of-service equipment tag Ref. 1926.1417(f)(1)	Equipment taken out of service has a tag in the cab saying it is out of service and must not be used.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Out-of-service function tag Ref. 1926.1417(f)(1)	Any function taken out of service has a tag in a conspicuous position saying that function must not be used.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Before starting and operator conduct

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
9	Do-not-operate sign on equipment Ref. 1926.1417(f)(2)(i)	No tag-out or do not operate sign on the equipment or starting control, or it was removed by an authorized person, or the operator verified no one is in a dangerous position on the machine and it is repaired and working properly.	☐	☐	☐	
10	Signs on other controls Ref. 1926.1417(f)(2)(ii)	No switch or control carrying a warning sign is activated unless the sign was removed by an authorized person or both (f)(2)(i)(A) and (B) conditions were verified.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Controls and personnel before engine start Ref. 1926.1417(g)	All controls in the proper starting position and all personnel in the clear before the engine is started.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Written repair report Ref. 1926.1417(j)(1)	Needed adjustments or repairs reported promptly in writing to the designated person and, on successive shifts, the next operator.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Shift-start notice Ref. 1926.1417(j)(2)	Affected employees told at the start of the shift about needed adjustments or repairs and all alternative measures.	☐	☐	☐	
14	No distractions Ref. 1926.1417(d)	Operator not using a cell phone or doing anything else that diverts attention while operating, except phone use for signal communications.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Safety devices and operational aids Ref. 1926.1417(k)	Operator exercises professional judgment and does not rely on safety devices or operational aids as a substitute for it.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Stop signals Ref. 1926.1417(y)	Operator obeys any stop or emergency stop signal, whoever gives it.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Capacity, brakes, rope and counterweight

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
17	Rated capacity Ref. 1926.1417(o)(1)	Load and configuration within the equipment's rated capacity per the load chart.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Load weight: source or calculation (method i) Ref. 1926.1417(o)(3)(i)	Where this method is used, load weight comes from an industry-recognized source or calculation method, or other equally reliable means, and was given to the operator before the lift when requested.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Load weight: indicator check (method ii) Ref. 1926.1417(o)(3)(ii)	Where this method is used, the operator began hoisting with a load weighing device, load moment indicator, rated capacity indicator or rated capacity limiter; if the load exceeded 75 percent of maximum rated capacity at the longest radius of the lift, the lift did not proceed until the weight was verified by method i.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Counterweight in place Ref. 1926.1417(aa)(1)(i)	Equipment other than tower cranes has the counterweight or ballast the manufacturer specifies installed.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION C | Capacity, brakes, rope and counterweight

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
21	Counterweight not exceeded Ref. 1926.1417(aa)(1)(ii)	Counterweight or ballast does not exceed the manufacturer's specified maximum.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Brake test on heavy loads Ref. 1926.1417(s)	Brakes tested by lifting a few inches and applying them whenever the load is at least 90% of maximum line pull (first lift only in repetitive duty cycles at that level).	☐	☐	☐	
23	Rope wraps on drums Ref. 1926.1417(t)	At least two full wraps of rope remain on the load and boom drums at the lowest point of travel.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Brake adjustment Ref. 1926.1417(x)	Brakes adjusted to manufacturer procedures with no unintended movement.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Load handling and travel

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
25	Clear of obstructions Ref. 1926.1417(p)	Boom and other parts of the equipment do not contact any obstruction.	☐	☐	☐	
26	No side loading Ref. 1926.1417(q)	Equipment is not dragging or pulling loads sideways.	☐	☐	☐	
27	Wheel-mounted front area Ref. 1926.1417(r)	No loads lifted over the front area of wheel-mounted equipment unless the manufacturer permits it.	☐	☐	☐	
28	Swing speed Ref. 1926.1417(v)	Rotation slow enough that the load stays within the radius at which it can be controlled.	☐	☐	☐	
29	Tag or restraint line Ref. 1926.1417(w)	Tag or restraint line in use wherever load rotation would be hazardous.	☐	☐	☐	
30	Suspended load attended Ref. 1926.1417(e)(1)	Operator at the controls whenever a load is suspended, unless every condition in (e)(1) is met.	☐	☐	☐	
31	Travel permitted Ref. 1926.1417(u)(1)	No travel with a load where the manufacturer prohibits it.	☐	☐	☐	
32	Travel supervised Ref. 1926.1417(u)(2)(i)	A competent person supervises travel with a load and has set load position, boom location, ground support, route, overhead obstructions, speed and any capacity reduction.	☐	☐	☐	
33	Travel determinations implemented Ref. 1926.1417(u)(2)(ii)	The competent person's travel determinations are being carried out during the move.	☐	☐	☐	
34	Tire pressure Ref. 1926.1417(u)(2)(iii)	Tires at the manufacturer's specified pressure when traveling with a load.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Weather, slack rope and locomotive cranes

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
35	Storm warning Ref. 1926.1417(h)	When a local storm warning is issued, the competent person has decided whether to apply the manufacturer's recommendations for securing the equipment.	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION E | Weather, slack rope and locomotive cranes

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
36	Wind, ice and snow Ref. 1926.1417(n)	Competent person has adjusted equipment or operations for the effect of wind, ice and snow on stability and rated capacity.	☐	☐	☐	
37	Slack rope re-spooling Ref. 1926.1417(m)	Where slack rope required re-spooling, the rope was seen seated on the drum and in the sheaves before lifting began.	☐	☐	☐	
38	Locomotive crane swing Ref. 1926.1417(z)	Locomotive crane not swung where railway cars on an adjacent track could strike it until it is determined cars are not being moved on that track and proper flag protection is in place.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME

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